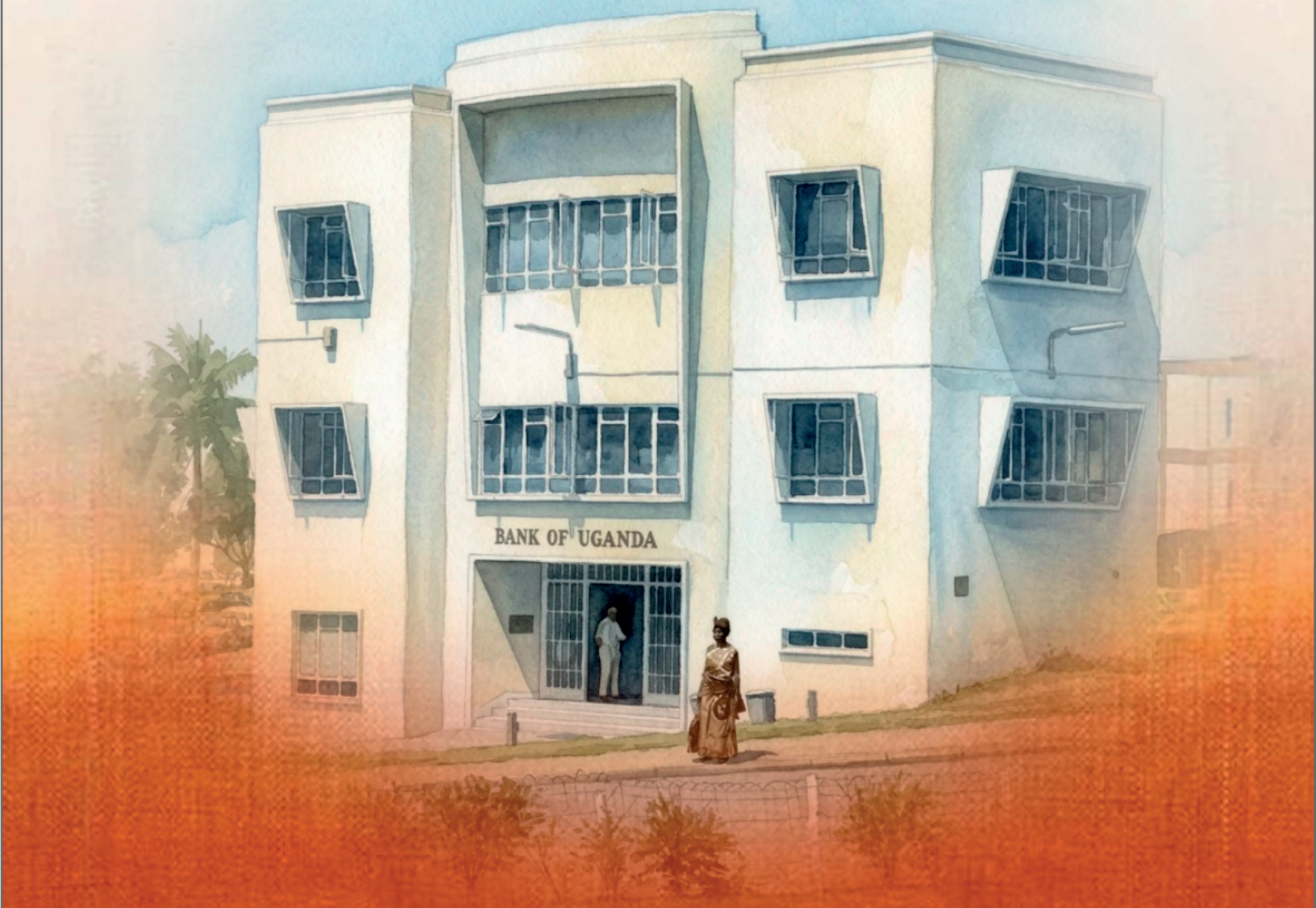
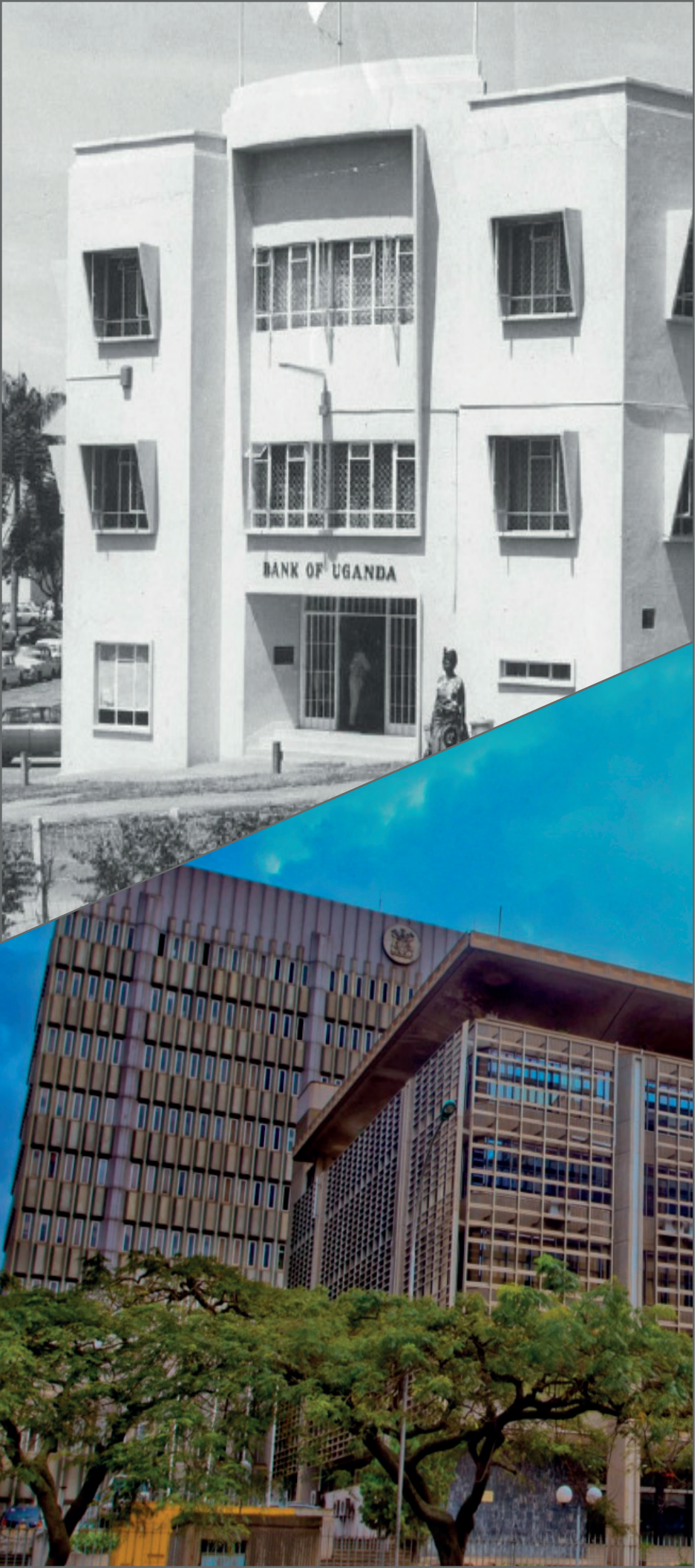
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Our Legacy, Our Future



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BANK OF UGANDA



MONETARY POLICY STATEMENT - at a glance

February, 2026

MONETARY POLICY OBJECTIVE

- **Maintain average annual core inflation as close as possible to the medium-term target of 5%.** *Core inflation is the change in the price of goods and services, excluding prices of items like food crops, oil prices and administered prices-e.g. water & electricity, which change rapidly and are beyond the control of policy actions.*



MONETARY POLICY INSTRUMENT

- ***To achieve its monetary policy objective, the* Bank of Uganda uses the Central Bank Rate (CBR).** *Changes in the CBR are intended to influence short-term interbank and other interest rates in the economy, ultimately affecting the cost of borrowing and the return on savings.*

WHAT DECISION HAS BEEN TAKEN AND WHY?

- Bank of Uganda has **maintained** the Central Bank Rate (CBR) at **9.75%** in **February 2026**.
- This stance remains appropriate to support economic activity while ensuring inflation stabilises around the target, amid persistent global uncertainty

CBR 9.75%

KEY DEVELOPMENTS



INFLATION:

Over the past year, core inflation averaged 3.8% and overall inflation averaged 3.5%. *Inflation remains low, supported by prudent monetary policy, coordination with fiscal policy, a stable exchange rate, declining global inflation, and favourable food and energy prices.*

ECONOMIC GROWTH:

Economic activity remained steady, with average growth of 6.3% during the first three quarters of 2025. *Growth was driven mainly by strong consumption, especially government spending, alongside household demand.*



WHAT DOES THE FUTURE HOLD?

INFLATION:

Inflation is projected to range between 3.8% and 4.3% in 2026, before stabilising around the 5% target over the medium to long term.



Factors that could raise Inflation:

- Stronger domestic demand partly driven by higher government spending
- A persistently weaker exchange rate
- Escalating geopolitical tensions disrupting global supply chains
- Poor weather reducing agricultural output



Factors that could lower Inflation:

- Declining global commodity prices
- Slower domestic economic activity
- Weak global growth due to trade shocks & heightened uncertainty



GROWTH:

The economy is projected to grow in the range of 6.5% and 7.0% in FY2025/26 and average about 8% in the medium term.

Factors that could support Growth:

- Large-scale infrastructure investments
- Sustained private investment
- Improved global financial conditions

Factors that could constrain Growth:

- Geopolitical tensions disrupting trade and supply chains
- Higher global commodity prices
- Weak global demand

Word from the Editor-in-Chief



Kenneth Egesa

Director, Communications and Public Relations Department

As the Bank of Uganda marks sixty years of service, this edition arrives at a moment that is both reflective and forward-looking. The contributions in this issue, though diverse, collectively tell the story of an institution that has grown in complexity and capability—anchored by people who continue to shape its trajectory.

Several articles revisit our foundations and evolution. The reflection on 60 years of central banking situates the Bank within Uganda's political and economic history, underscoring that institutional strength is built through professionalism, disciplined engagement, and adherence to mandate. Complementing this, the piece on why the milestone matters to staff brings the focus back to the individuals whose work sustains the Bank's credibility.

This link between history and people is deepened in the profiles of the Monetary Policy Department. The Architecture of Price Stability and A Department That Built a Generation highlight both the technical depth behind monetary policy and the Department's role in shaping leadership and institutional knowledge, reminding us that strong institutions are built over time.

Transformation is a central theme across this edition. The rollout of the Procurement and Disposal System (BPDS) signals progress toward digitisation and efficiency, while discussions on cash in a digitalising economy and trade in services reflect a more nuanced and evolving economic landscape.

The edition also captures the human dimension of institutional performance. Reflections on personal growth, burnout, and financial discipline reinforce that effectiveness depends on individual well-being. My data detective odyssey stands out as a testament to curiosity and initiative in driving innovation.

Together, these contributions invite reflection on how we balance continuity with change and individual growth with collective purpose. As we enter the Bank's seventh decade, the message is clear: our legacy is not only inherited but is also actively built through our decisions and commitment to the future.





60 years of central banking in Uganda: politics and the central banking role

Ronnie Kyamureku Alinda, Statistics Department

As the Bank of Uganda marks 60 years of service, it is fitting to not only celebrate longevity but also reflect on the BoU's institutional character in the context of Uganda's political history, with which it is intertwined. Central banks exist to provide stability and continuity in the financial sector by stewarding monetary policy, safeguarding financial stability, and anchoring confidence in the currency. However, they do not operate in isolation. They function within sovereign states, alongside national governments and the bureaucratic structure, and must stay consistent even during periods of intense political change. This anniversary invites reflection on how coordination with government within the law strengthens rather than weakens a central bank.

Traditionally, BoU anniversary celebrations often highlight the Bank's first Governor, Joseph Mary Mubiru (1966-1971), whose tenure coincided with one of the most defining periods in Uganda's political history. Those years offer important lessons on how the BoU interacted with government during moments of constitutional change, ideological shifts, and even regime transitions. This reflection is particularly timely given that the BoU's 60th anniversary falls in an election year, having held Presidential and Parliamentary elections in January 2026. Election cycles are not merely political events; they are macroeconomic moments and provide perfect conditions to evaluate the relationship between central government and central banks. This tension between politics and macroeconomic stability is not unique to Uganda. Rogoff (1990) explains that election years create incentives for incumbent governments to adjust the composition and timing of fiscal and macroeconomic policy in ways that signal competence to voters, even when voters are rational and aware of such incentives. These dynamics can influence inflation expectations, exchange rate pressures, liquidity conditions, and credit demand—all variables central to the BoU's mandate.

This article highlights how a constructive relationship with government strengthens the central bank to provide the unique service it offers to the country, and the importance of institutional safeguards and professional integrity in protecting the BoU from political influence based on the historical events from 1966 to 1971.

Historical context: baby steps amid political transformation

As a former colony of Britain, the early history of the BoU is deeply connected with the Bank of England. The Bank of England was very instrumental in setting up the BoU, in effect seconding Bank of England staff on three-year contracts as expatriates in critical positions in the BoU during its establishment (Mutibwa, 2006). Mr Ian D Lewis as the Deputy Governor, Mr Anthony Parker as Exchange Controller, and Mr George Palmer Lambie as General Manager were responsible for establishing procedures for the operations of the accounts of the government and commercial banks.

Between 1966 and 1971, just as the BoU had started operations, Uganda experienced profound political shifts. A constitutional crisis in 1966 led to the collapse of the federal arrangement and centralisation of executive authority. This affected the BoU as the central government amended the Bank Act in 1966 to introduce the Secretary to the Treasury as an ex-officio member of the Board of Directors at the BoU (Mutibwa, 2006, p. 174). This setup, while it was initially meant to ensure the interests of Ugandans are served in the way the BoU operates, still stands today and has been a very instrumental avenue through which the Ministry of Finance and the BoU align their policy actions. The Bank of Uganda Act 2000 (Section 8(a)) further designates that the Board members should be citizens of Uganda, a departure from the presence of expatriates in 1966 and the early years.

By 1969-1970, Uganda had effectively become a one-party state, and the 'Common Man's Charter' signalled a move towards socialist-oriented economic reforms, including nationalisation of foreign-owned enterprises, including British banks. The great influence of expatriates at the BoU, the Governor's close relationship with the Bank of England management, and the fate of Uganda's first president, Kabaka Frederick Muteesa II, an exile to England, made the political leadership very suspicious of Governor Joseph Mubiru on account of his tribe and links to the Bank of England (Mutibwa, 2006).

Mutibwa documents that in December 1969, an assassination attempt on President Obote brought more trouble to Governor Mubiru, such that in March 1970, Joseph Mubiru was put under house arrest, his home and office searched, and his brother-in-law taken away by the police, all presumably on suspicion of links to the attempted assassination. Further to this tense political relationship with the President, there also were differences in opinion on the economic policy between the two, but the BoU continued in its primary mandate with Governor Mubiru reporting to duty as soon as his house arrest ended.

From socialism to military dictatorship: further integration despite challenges

In January 1971, a military coup led by General Idi Amin ushered in a new political order. Despite the abrupt transition, the BoU remained operational, continuing currency issuance and conducting government banking business.

Within six days of the coup, on 31 January 1971, the BoU formally wrote to the new President, congratulating him and advising the need to 'make a clear demarcation between areas restricted to state enterprises and areas to be left to private initiative' to revive the economy. This was followed by a meeting between the Governor and President Amin, after which the BoU prepared an 11-page memorandum titled The Financial Situation in Uganda. The memorandum recommended reducing government expenditure, clarifying nationalisation policy, and establishing a coherent approach to non-citizens to guide exchange control policy with Kenya and Tanzania (Mutibwa, 2006, p. 202).

This early engagement was not an act of subordination but of institutional responsibility. By initiating dialogue and presenting technical analysis, the BoU signalled its readiness to work with the new political leadership while remaining anchored in its mandate. The strength of the relationship lay in clarity of roles: government determined political direction; the central bank provided professional economic counsel grounded in macroeconomic stability.

On 5 June 1971, Governor Mubiru further requested that, in his capacity as economic and financial adviser to government, he be permitted to attend Cabinet discussions on economic and financial matters. While this may have created institutional sensitivities, it underscored a critical principle: central bank independence does not require detachment from government decision-making. Rather, it requires disciplined engagement within defined statutory boundaries.

Given the significant foreign ownership in Uganda's banking sector at the time, the BoU sought to promote a stable and predictable policy environment to restore investor confidence and ease pressure on foreign exchange and the balance of payments (Mutibwa, 2006, pp. 210, 213). Even amid political upheaval, the BoU pursued structured coordination to reduce uncertainty and safeguard macroeconomic stability.

Conclusion: government relationship a source of legitimacy, not weakness

The actions of Governor Joseph Mubiru and his team at the BoU within the changing political, constitutional, and economic environment in seeking institutional partnership with government, even in the difficult times, offer a valuable lesson. A central bank derives its authority from legislation enacted by government. Its mandate, objectives, and governance framework are defined by law. This relationship is not a vulnerability; it is a source of democratic legitimacy. In 1968 and 1969, amendments to the Bank of Uganda Act and the enactment of the Banking Act introduced structural changes, including provisions for

government representation on the Board and presidential appointment of senior leadership (Mutibwa, 2006). These reforms reflected the broader political economy of the time, in which most of the BoU senior management were British and the central government felt it needed more representation in the BoU's affairs.

Yet institutional design matters more than political context. Even where governments appoint central bank leadership or participate in governance structures, operational independence can remain intact when:

•Policy decisions are anchored in statute and clearly communicated. Regular reporting, monetary policy statements, and public engagement anchor expectations and reinforce accountability and consistency to predetermined policy goals.

•Terms of office are fixed and protected. The contract of Joseph Mubiru was due to expire in 1971, and despite differences with the central government, he served out his contract to expiry. This enables top management to act in line with their convictions.

•Mandates are clearly defined. The Bank of Uganda Act defines price stability and financial stability as core objectives. A clear mandate constrains discretionary political demands.

•Decisions are guided by data and transparent frameworks. Monetary policy decisions are grounded in empirical analysis, macroeconomic models, and forward-looking indicators. Evidence-based frameworks reduce the scope for arbitrary intervention.

•Institutional continuity. Unlike political administrations, central banks operate across electoral cycles. This continuity stabilises expectations even during political transitions.

•Separation of instruments. While fiscal authorities determine taxation and expenditure, central banks control monetary instruments such as interest rates and liquidity management. This division of tools limits political distortions.

In this way, government involvement does not necessarily translate into political interference. Rather, it establishes the legal framework within which independence is exercised.

Lessons for the present and future

The story of the BoU over 60 years is not a story of detachment from government as things got difficult but of structuring the partnership within the law to maintain a strong working relationship. The BoU has operated under constitutional governments, one-party systems, and military regimes. Through each period, its survival depended on professionalism, technical competence, and adherence to mandate. When mandates are clear, processes are transparent, and decisions are data-driven, government relationship becomes a channel for legitimacy rather than a conduit for influence.

For current BoU staff, this history offers practical guidance on how institutional partnership, when conducted within statutory safeguards, is not a compromise of independence but an expression of institutional maturity. Independence does not mean isolation. It means disciplined autonomy within a constitutional framework. It means partnership without partisanship. This is the legacy of Joseph Mubiru's tenure as Governor, and it should be our charge for the future. May his soul rest in peace.

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Celebrating 60 Years of BoU: Why This Milestone Matters to Staff

Sylvia Juuko, Communications & PR Department

On 15 August 2026, the Bank of Uganda (BoU) will mark a significant milestone: 60 years since its establishment. This diamond jubilee is a recognition of resilience, transformation, and the collective commitment that has shaped Uganda's central bank into a pillar of national stability and progress.

For staff, this anniversary is both an occasion for reflection and a reaffirmation of purpose, underscoring the vital contribution everyone makes to the Bank's enduring legacy and future direction.

A Foundation Built on Service and Resilience

The history of BoU is closely intertwined that of Uganda. Established in August 1966, in the aftermath of independence and the dissolution of the East African Currency Board, the Bank was entrusted with the responsibility of issuing national currency, managing monetary policy, and safeguarding financial stability. Its early years were characterised by both institutional promise and considerable adversity. As recorded in the BoU@50 commemorative publication, The Golden Odyssey: Bank of Uganda 1966 - 2016, the Bank navigated political upheavals, economic crises, and the considerable challenge of building a central bank from its foundations.

Staff members, from the inaugural cohort of 56 employees in 1966 to a workforce of over 1,000 today (BoU Records, 2024), have been central to this institutional journey. Their dedication, professionalism, and adaptability have enabled the Bank to navigate periods of uncertainty, implement critical reforms, and establish its reputation as a respected institution at both the national and international level.

Institutional Transformation and Professional Development

Over six decades, BoU has evolved from a nascent regulatory authority into a modern, operationally independent central bank. Key reforms during the 1990s, codified in the 1995 Constitution and subsequent legislation, established the Bank's mandate clearly: to foster price stability and a sound financial system. These reforms were both structural and cultural in nature, embedding the values of Transparency, Integrity, Teamwork, and Ethical behavior known as the TITE framework, which continues to define the Bank's organisational character.

For staff, this transformation has provided opportunities for professional growth, continuous learning, and meaningful participation in shaping the Bank's strategic direction. The introduction of structured planning processes, merit-based recruitment, and comprehensive training programmes has cultivated a workforce that is both technically proficient and deeply committed to the Bank's public mandate.

Staff at the Centre of the Bank's Mission

Behind every policy decision, technological advancement, or regulatory reform are the staff members who give those changes meaning and effect. The BoU@50 publication documents the contributions of staff who have served through periods of uncertainty, adapted to successive technological revolutions, and upheld the Bank's reputation for integrity and institutional competence.

From the first Ugandan Governor, Mr. Joseph Mubiru, whose tenure established a standard of public service and excellence, to the many staff members whose work across every department sustains the Bank's day-to-day functions, the institution's achievements reflect collective effort at every level.

The Bank's commitment to staff welfare, expressed through competitive remuneration, comprehensive benefits, and a supportive working environment, has fostered sustained loyalty and institutional pride. Initiatives such as the in-house pension fund, flexible working arrangements, and opportunities for further education reflect a recognition that the Bank's people represent the foundation of its institutional capacity.

Why the 60th Anniversary Matters

1. A Moment for Reflection and Renewal

Institutional anniversaries are more than ceremonial occasions; they provide an opportunity to reflect on the journey undertaken, honour the contributions of those who have served, and renew commitment to shared values. For BoU staff, the 60th anniversary offers the opportunity to recognise achievements, acknowledge the challenges that have been overcome, and draw from that experience a source of resolve for the future. It is a reminder that everyone's work, whether in policy, operations, research, or support services, contributes directly to the Bank's mission and to Uganda's broader economic well-being.

2. Affirming the Bank's National Role

The history of BoU is inseparable from Uganda's economic development. The Bank has played a central role in managing inflation, maintaining currency stability, supervising financial institutions, and advancing financial inclusion. Staff have been instrumental in implementing the policies and programmes that have enabled Uganda to withstand global economic shocks, attract investment, and sustain growth. The 60th anniversary affirms the Bank's role as a steward of national economic stability and a contributor to long-term progress.

3. Celebrating Organisational Culture and Values

The Bank's culture, anchored in the TITE values, has been a source of cohesion and institutional resilience. The anniversary is an occasion to celebrate this culture, recognise the contributions of staff, and reinforce the behaviours that underpin the Bank's effectiveness. It is equally a moment to reflect on the importance of diversity, inclusion, and equal opportunity, all of which have enriched the workforce and broadened the Bank's institutional capacity.

4. Embracing Change and Innovation

From the introduction of electronic payment systems to the adoption of inflation targeting and, more recently, the ongoing process of digital transformation, BoU has demonstrated a consistent capacity for institutional adaptation. Staff have been at the forefront of these developments, acquiring new capabilities, engaging with evolving technologies, and driving continuous improvement across operations. The 60th anniversary is an opportunity to recognise this culture of innovation and to affirm the importance of remaining responsive to future challenges.

5. Inspiring the Next Generation of Staff

As the Bank considers the future, the anniversary serves as an important reference point for new and developing staff. It is a reminder that the legacy of BoU is built continuously through the daily actions, professional judgements, and integrity of its people. By drawing on the lessons of the past and maintaining a clear orientation toward the future, staff at all levels can contribute to ensuring that the Bank remains an institution of excellence for generations to come.

The Next Chapter

The journey to sixty years has been defined by resilience, adaptability, and a steadfast commitment to public service. As BoU enters its seventh decade, new challenges and opportunities will continue to arise, including technological disruption, evolving financial sector dynamics, and the broader imperative of sustainable and inclusive economic development.

Staff will remain central to the Bank's response, drawing on a well-established institutional legacy and a shared commitment to the future. The 60th anniversary is a reaffirmation of the Bank's purpose and an acknowledgement of the people who have made that purpose possible. For staff, it represents an opportunity to take stock of a significant institutional contribution, to draw motivation from a distinguished record of service, and to recognise that their work matters to both the institution and to the nation it serves.



Bank of Uganda Procurement and Disposal System (BPDS) Implementation Takes Off

Dr. George Wilson Ssonko, Procurement and Disposal Department



The Bank of Uganda has officially commenced the implementation of the Bank of Uganda Procurement and Disposal System (BPDS) under the Oracle e-Business Suite (EBS) environment. This strategic initiative represents a major step in digitising, securing, and strengthening our procurement and disposal processes across the BoU.

According to the approved Project Management Plan (PMP), the project entails a two-phase implementation of Oracle Sourcing, Oracle Supplier Lifecycle Management, Oracle Procurement Contracts, and Oracle iSupplier Portal, supported by Single Sign-On (SSO) and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) for enhanced security. The implementation follows the Oracle Unified Method (OUM), covering Inception, Elaboration, Construction, Transition, and Production phases to ensure structured governance, quality assurance, and risk management.

Why BPDS? Strategic value and relevance

The BPDS is not merely a system upgrade; it is a strategic reform aligned with the BoU Strategic Plan (2022-2027); Public Procurement and Disposal of Public Assets (PPDA) Act Cap 205 and PPDA Regulations 2023; and Uganda's National e-Government Procurement (e-GP) reforms. The objectives of the BPDS project include reducing manual tasks, optimising workflows, preventing fraud through audit trails, improving compliance, and enabling real-time reporting for decision-making. These objectives are in alignment with the strategic objective of 'Improve Efficiency and Reliability of Bank Processes' and directly support the BoU's mandate of maintaining price and financial stability as well as financial system development.

In an analysis of Procurement and Disposal Department (PDD) data from FY2023/24 to FY2025/26 (Figure 1), using the Kraljic Matrix as the Procurement and Disposal Categorisation Model, the data indicates that 67 percent of the BoU's procurement transactions fall under Routine Items while only 3 percent comprise Strategic Items. Leverage Items account for 26 percent and Bottleneck Items 4 percent.

This distribution highlights a procurement environment dominated by high-volume, low-risk routine activities, which consume significant administrative effort but contribute minimally to strategic value, underscoring the need for automation of such transactions.

The increasing trend in Leverage and Bottleneck Items as highlighted in Figure 2 suggests rising operational dependencies and expanding opportunities for consolidated sourcing. Meanwhile, the relatively small but critical Strategic Items require deeper supplier engagement, rigorous risk management, and stronger contract governance.

Globally, empirical studies from the World Bank and Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) indicate that digital procurement systems reduce procurement cycle time by 20-40%; lower administrative transaction costs by 10-25%; increase supplier competition by up to 30%; and reduce procurement-related irregularities by 15-20% due to auditability and transparency.

Uganda's national e-GP system has demonstrated improved transparency, supplier participation, and reduced paper-based inefficiencies across Ministries, Departments, and Agencies (MDAs). BPDS positions the BoU to align with these national reforms while strengthening internal controls at a central banking standard.

What the system will do

The BPDS will digitise end-to-end procurement processes across four key modules:

(a) Oracle Sourcing: Supports RFIs (Request for Information)/RFQs (Request for Quotation) (including two-stage technical and commercial evaluations), supplier invitations, scoring, automated closures, online collaboration, and award approvals.

(b) Oracle Procurement Contracts: Enables creation and approval of reusable templates, clauses, terms and conditions, and structured contract governance.

(c) Oracle Supplier Lifecycle Management: Provides 360-degree supplier profiling, registration, onboarding, qualification management, and approval workflows.

(d) Oracle iSupplier Portal: Allows suppliers to submit quotes, track awards, monitor shipment and invoice status, and participate in discussions electronically.

Additionally, SSO and MFA will be implemented across both new and existing EBS modules to strengthen authentication and cybersecurity posture.

Benefits to user Departments

1.Faster procurement cycle: Automated workflows, structured approvals, and system-based RFQs reduce manual bottlenecks. Empirical evidence shows digitisation reduces processing time by up to 40%.

2.Improved compliance: System-enforced approval hierarchies, segregation of duties, and audit trails ensure adherence to PPDA and internal policies. Audit trail enablement is explicitly incorporated in the project assumptions.

3.Fraud risk reduction: Secure MFA authentication, encrypted access, and complete transaction logs reduce manipulation risk and enhance traceability.

4.Transparency and supplier confidence: Online RFQs (sealed and public), scoring dashboards, and structured evaluation workflows enhance fairness and competition.

5.Real-time reporting: Dashboards and system reports enable evidence-based planning and budget utilisation monitoring.

6.Paperless and cost savings: Reduction in stationery use and document handling aligns with cost efficiency and sustainability objectives.

Implementation structure and governance

The implementation is structured in two phases, covering configuration and development of 28 custom extensions (CEMLIs), with defined testing stages: Conference Room Pilot 1 (CRP1), CRP2, System Integration Testing (SIT), and User Acceptance Testing (UAT).

User Departments will actively participate in workshops and requirements validation; UAT execution (four weeks across phases); and business process alignment. Oracle Consulting will provide structured post-go-live support (hypercare) for up to four weeks for EBS modules and two weeks for SSO/MFA.

The project also includes a clearly defined Risk Management Plan, with identified risks such as unavailability of personnel, scope changes, decision delays, and change management challenges. Active participation of user Departments is therefore critical.

What this means for you

Business process alignment: The BoU has undertaken the requisite efforts to ensure that necessary business process changes will be made to conform to standard Oracle workflows. This means some existing manual or informal practices may be redesigned.

Active UAT participation: User Departments will lead UAT testing, validating that system configurations meet business needs.

Change management responsibility: Organisational Change Management is outside the Oracle scope and as such shall be handled by the Change Management Team in PDD. Therefore, internal ownership of adoption, communication, and behavioural alignment is essential.

Security compliance: With SSO/MFA activation, users must comply with enhanced authentication requirements, including One Time Password (OTP) verification via email/Short Message Service (SMS) or mobile authenticator.

Critical success factors

For successful implementation, user Departments must ensure availability of key staff during workshops and UAT; timely decision-making; clean master data preparation; and adherence to defined scope and change control processes. Empirical research consistently shows that digital procurement projects succeed not because of technology alone but because of leadership commitment, user ownership, and disciplined governance.

The way forward

The BPDS is a strategic enabler that will strengthen internal controls; enhance public trust; improve value-for-money outcomes; and align the BoU with global central banking best practices in digital procurement. This is not simply a system implementation; it is an institutional transformation initiative.

All user Departments are therefore encouraged to actively engage, provide timely feedback, and embrace the new digital workflows as we transition toward a more transparent, efficient, and secure procurement environment. Together, we are building a procurement system worthy of a modern central bank.





The Architecture of Price Stability

Dr. Elizabeth Kasekende, Monetary Policy Department

At the heart of the Bank of Uganda (BoU)'s mandate to achieve and maintain price stability sits a department whose work shapes the economic conditions that every Ugandan navigates daily. The Monetary Policy Department is the analytical and intellectual engine through which the Bank formulates monetary policy, translating vast flows of economic data into evidence-based recommendations. The recommendations then guide consequential decisions on interest rates, inflation management, and the country's broader macroeconomic trajectory.

Led by Dr. Elizabeth Kasekende, the department is organised into three specialised divisions: the Monetary Policy Analysis Division, headed by Ms. Doreen Rubatsimbira; the Research Bureau and External Relations Division, headed by Mr. Edward Tenywa; and the Macroeconomic Forecasting Division, headed by Mr. Sulaiman Nyanzi. The Department currently comprises 26 staff members, including economists and one administrative assistant.

Each division brings a distinct area of technical expertise to bear on the shared objective of ensuring that Uganda's monetary policy rests on rigorous, forward-looking, and well-communicated economic analysis. Together, they form a professional unit that spans economic research, advanced modelling, macroeconomic forecasting, external engagement, and policy communication. Despite its relatively compact size, it is a dynamic, vibrant, and highly creative team that plays a central role in the Bank's analytical and policy work. The team brings together strong technical expertise and a collaborative spirit, enabling the Department to effectively deliver on its mandate of providing high-quality economic analysis and policy support.

The department's mandate is broad and deeply embedded in the institutional architecture of the Bank. Economic surveillance and macroeconomic analysis form the foundation of its work, with teams continuously monitoring key indicators including inflation, gross domestic product growth, exchange rates, and interest rates, and producing the timely forecasts and diagnostics on which monetary policy decisions rest.

This analytical function feeds directly into technical support for the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC), for which the department develops policy options, conducts scenario analysis, simulates economic outcomes, and prepares policy briefs that inform decisions on the Central Bank Rate (CBR) and foreign exchange interventions. Representation and advocacy extend these contributions outward, ensuring that Uganda's macroeconomic position is coherently advanced in national, regional, and international forums.

Collaboration is integral to how the department operates. Externally, it coordinates activities with regional economic communities, government ministries and agencies, international financial institutions, sovereign credit rating agencies, and research bodies in which the Bank holds strategic interests.

Internally, it works across directorates to ensure coherence in macroeconomic frameworks, align research inputs, and support consistent economic communication throughout the institution. This engagement across institutional boundaries, both beyond and within the Bank, allows the department to anchor its technical work simultaneously in global best practice and domestic operational realities.

The department is also the custodian of the Bank's most substantive economic publications. The Monetary Policy Statement, the State of the Economy Report, the Inflation Outlook Reports, and a series of research working papers and policy briefs together constitute a body of public-facing knowledge that serves both institutional accountability and the elevation of economic discourse in Uganda. These publications are produced on a regular cycle and are increasingly recognised as authoritative references among policymakers, analysts, and development partners across the region.

Over the years, the department's achievements have been substantial and measurable. Its most consequential contribution has been the consistent technical support provided to the MPC, enabling evidence-based monetary policy decisions that have helped maintain low and stable inflation in Uganda over an extended period.

Complementing this has been the progressive refinement of the Forecasting and Policy Analysis System (FPAS), which integrates Dynamic Stochastic General Equilibrium (DSGE) modelling, nowcasting techniques, and the Quarterly Projection Model (QPM) to improve the accuracy, robustness, and policy relevance of macroeconomic forecasts, drawing on real-time data from multiple sources.

At the regional and international level, the department's sustained engagement with the East African Community (EAC), the International Monetary Fund (IMF), and sovereign credit rating agencies has helped to establish and consolidate credibility for Uganda's monetary policy framework on global platforms.

Candour about challenges is part of the department's institutional character. The rapidly changing global economic environment, marked by commodity price volatility, exchange rate pressures, geopolitical tensions, and climate-related shocks, has increased the complexity and uncertainty of medium-term forecasting. This has necessitated the department to develop greater analytical resilience and adaptability.

Continued reliance on legacy systems and gaps in real-time data infrastructure have at times constrained the depth and speed of analysis, though investment in upgrading tools and adopting more integrated data and forecasting platforms is actively under way.

Translating technically complex economic analysis into clear and accessible communication for non-technical audiences and the wider public remains a persistent area for development, particularly in fast-moving policy environments where the timing and clarity of communication matter as much as the rigour of the underlying work.

One of the most defining moments for the Department occurred in July 2011, when the Bank transitioned from a quantitative monetary policy framework to an Inflation Targeting Lite (ITL) regime. This shift marked a fundamental change in the conduct of monetary policy, from focusing primarily on monetary aggregates to a price-based framework centred on the policy interest rate and inflation management. For the Department, this was a profound institutional moment, as it required the development of new analytical tools, forecasting frameworks, and communication strategies.

The transition also demanded significant effort in public communication and policy engagement, as the Bank had to explain to stakeholders, markets, and the broader public how the new framework would improve macroeconomic management and strengthen the credibility of monetary policy.

Importantly, the shift did not imply discarding previous knowledge and institutional experience. Rather, it involved building on the legacy of earlier frameworks while adopting more forward-looking and market-based policy processes that aligned with evolving global best practices in central banking.

Looking ahead, the department is oriented towards becoming a more agile, data-driven, and analytically sophisticated policy unit. Investment in advanced forecasting models, scenario analysis tools, and machine learning applications is expected to improve both the precision and the speed of analytical output, enabling more responsive recommendations in a dynamic economic landscape.

The department is also well-positioned to benefit from the integrated, real-time data platforms being developed by the Statistics Department, which will facilitate high-frequency monitoring of key economic indicators and support more timely policy responses to external shocks.

The research agenda has been deliberately broadened to encompass emerging issues including climate change and its fiscal dimensions, digital financial services, external vulnerabilities, and financial inclusion, all of which will define the policy landscape for the coming decade and require the kind of interdisciplinary depth the department is actively cultivating.

Within the department, the culture is deliberately collegial. Team-building retreats are organised periodically to strengthen relationships and foster trust. Departmental celebrations mark key milestones, from the delivery of major publications to personal achievements among staff. Open-door leadership encourages transparent communication and idea-sharing across all levels, and flexible work arrangements reflect a genuine commitment to the well-being and work-life balance of staff.

Mentorship and knowledge-sharing are embedded in daily practice through joint research, regular training, and in-house seminars and workshops. This investment in people is not incidental to the department's technical mission but an active component of sustaining the analytical capacity on which all its output depends. For stakeholders across the Bank and the wider economy, the Monetary Policy Department offers a clear and consistent undertaking: rigorous, timely, and transparent economic analysis in service of Uganda's macroeconomic stability, delivered with the highest standards of integrity and professional conduct.

The department asks its partners and collaborators for the same qualities it holds itself to, including timely and accurate data sharing, active cross-functional engagement, responsiveness to technical exchange, and a spirit of empirical inquiry that advances the Bank's standing as a research-driven institution. As the Bank of Uganda marks sixty years of service to the nation, the Monetary Policy Department stands as one of the enduring institutional expressions of that commitment.



A Department That Built a Generation

Duncan Roy Kawooya, Monetary Policy Department

The Monetary Policy Department, originally established as the Research Department in 1966, is one of the founding departments of the Bank of Uganda. It was among five departments operating during the period 1966 to 1971, alongside the Banking Department, the Exchange Control Department, the Department of Supervision, and the Governor's Office.
Early Location

The Department was originally housed at the Bank's former headquarters at Liverpool House on Parliamentary Avenue, where operations commenced during the early years of the institution's establishment.

Evolution and Restructuring

Over the years, the Department has evolved through several restructurings aimed at streamlining its activities and enhancing institutional efficiency. The most recent change involved renaming the Department to the Monetary Policy Department, a shift from its previous designations, which included Monetary Policy and Economic Research, Economic Research, and Research Department. The current name more accurately reflects the focused nature of the analysis and core activities the Department undertakes.

Functions That Evolved from the Department

Over the years, the Department has served as a foundational hub for several key functions that were subsequently restructured and reassigned to other departments in response to the Bank's evolving institutional needs. These include the following:

i.Archives Function. Initially managed within the Department as part of the Information and Publications Division, this function was subsequently transferred to the Board Affairs Department to better align with corporate governance and institutional memory responsibilities.

ii.Knowledge Management Centre. The Knowledge Management Centre (KMC) was originally housed within the Department, at the time operating as the Bank Library. It was later transferred to the Communications & PR Department and subsequently relocated to the People and Culture Development Department, reflecting its growing role in staff learning and institutional knowledge retention.

iii.Real Sector Statistics. This function, once within the Department's purview, was reassigned to the Statistics Department to strengthen sectoral data generation and analytical capabilities. The unit was initially responsible for compiling the Index of Agricultural Production and estimating Domestic Resource Cost indicators. Over time, its scope expanded significantly, and it evolved into the Real Sector Statistics Division, reflecting the growing importance of structured real sector data in macroeconomic analysis and policy formulation.

iv.Monetary Statistics and External Sector Statistics. These functions were initially managed within the Department but were transferred to the Trade and External Debt Department and, subsequently, to the consolidated Statistics Department following a broader institutional restructuring. This transition merged elements from the former Trade and External Debt Division and the Research Department's Data Services Division, enabling a more integrated approach to statistical production and dissemination.

Leadership Legacy

Over the years, the Department has been guided by the leadership of 22 Directors, beginning with Professor Agathon A. A. Aerni at the Department's founding. The Directors of the Department are listed below, in reverse chronological order.

#	Director
1	Dr Elizabeth Kasekende
2	Dr. Jimmy Apaa
3	Ms. Christine Asiimwe Namanya
4	Dr. Jacob Opolot
5	Dr. Adam Mugume
6	Mrs. Mary Katarikawe
7	Dr. David Kihangire
8	Mr. Michael Atingi-Ego
9	Dr. Polycarp Musinguzi
10	Dr. Louis Kasekende
11	Dr. M Barret
12	Dr. Ezra Suruma
13	Dr. J Ofori-Atta
14	Mr. Leo Kibirango
15	Mr. B Vollan
16	Mr. C Lemme
17	Mr. W Vertongen
18	Mr. A S Njala May
19	Mr. Basil Wapensky
20	Mr. Francesco Fascoine
21	Mr. V M Paranjpe
22	Professor Agathon A. Aerni

For successful implementation, user Departments must ensure availability of key staff during workshops and UAT; timely decision-making; clean master data preparation; and adherence to defined scope and change control processes. Empirical research consistently shows that digital procurement projects succeed not because of technology alone but because of leadership commitment, user ownership, and disciplined governance.

The way forward

The BPDS is a strategic enabler that will strengthen internal controls; enhance public trust; improve value-for-money outcomes; and align the BoU with global central banking best practices in digital procurement. This is not simply a system implementation; it is an institutional transformation initiative.

All user Departments are therefore encouraged to actively engage, provide timely feedback, and embrace the new digital workflows as we transition toward a more transparent, efficient, and secure procurement environment. Together, we are building a procurement system worthy of a modern central bank.

Career Progression of Former Members to Senior Leadership Roles

In addition to the leadership provided within the Department, several former members have progressed to serve as Directors and Deputy Directors across other departments of the Bank. A number of these individuals are listed in the table below.

#	Director	Currrent Deployment	Former Roles Within Research and other Departments
1	Dr. Adam Mugume	Executive Director, Research and Policy	Director, Research and Policy
2	Dr. Jacob Opolot	Executive Director, Operations	Director, Research, Economic Advisor to Governor
3	Mr. Robert Mbabazize	Director, Financial Stability	Deputy Director, Financial Stability
4	Dr. Kenneth Egesa	Director, Communications and Public Relations	Director, Financial Stability; Director, Statistics; Deputy Director, External Sector Statistics
5	Mrs. Prisca Ampumuza Rwamahe	Director, Strategy and Innovation	Deputy Director, Human Resources, Deputy Director, Corporate Services
6	Dr. Jimmy Apaa	Director, Financial Markets	Deputy Director, Communications; Deputy Director, Economic Research
7	Ms. Christine Asiimwe Namanya	Director, Board Affairs	Deputy Director, Economic Research
8	Mr. Akura Mugyenyi	Deputy Director, Personal Assistant to the Governor	
9	Dr. Nicholas Okot	Deputy Director, Deputy Governor's Office	Deputy Director, Economic Research, Deputy Director Statistics
10	Ms. Constance Kabibi KImuli	Deputy Director Statistics	
11	Mr. Edward Tenywa	Deputy Director, Economic Research	Deputy Director, Deputy Governor's Office, Deputy Director Governor's Office
12	Mr. Sulaiman Nyanzi	Deputy Director, Economic Research	Deputy Director, Economic Research, Deputy Director Statistics
13	Dr. George Wilson Ssonko	Deputy Director, Procurement	
14	Mr. Victor Walusimbi	Deputy Director, Communications	Deputy Director, Board Affairs
15	Mrs. Denise Mugyenyi Ayume	Deputy Director, Board Affairs	
16	Mr. David Sajjabi	Retired	Former Director, Financial Markets
17	Mrs. Mary Katarikawe	Retired	Former Director Research, Director, Statistics
18	Dr. Charles Abuka	Retired	Former Executive Director, Operations; Director, Statistics; Director, Financial Stability
19	Dr. Polycarp Musinguzi	Retired	Former Economic Adviser to the Governor; Executive Director, General Duties
20	Dr. Justine Nannyonjo	Retired	Former Deputy Director, Research; Deputy Director, Research and Statistics
21	Mrs. Solome Lumala	Retired	Former Deputy Director, Research; Deputy Director, Research and Statistics
22	Mrs. Winifred Rwe-Beyanga	Retired	Former Deputy Director, Research
23	Mr. Rweikiza Rweyemamu	Retired	Former Deputy Director, Board Affairs

Institutional Contribution

The Department has made a notable contribution to the leadership of the Bank of Uganda, with four of its former staff members having gone on to serve as Governors or Deputy Governors: Mr. Leo Kibirango, Dr Ezra Suruma, Dr Louis Kasekende, and Mr. Michael Atingi-Ego.

The reach of the Department's alumni extends well beyond the Bank. Former members have gone on to serve Uganda and the international community in senior roles, including as Executive Director of the World Bank, as a finance minister, and in senior management positions at the International Monetary Fund (IMF), the African Development Bank (AfDB), and regional institutions including the Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa (COMESA) and the East African Community Secretariat. Dr Benon Mutambi has served as Permanent Secretary in the Ministry of Internal Affairs. Others have pursued paths in public service, academia, and the private sector; Mr. Ddamulira, for example, founded and leads St Mark's College Namagoma, one of the top-performing secondary schools in Uganda.

These trajectories underscore the Department's longstanding role as a foundation for leadership development within the Bank and reflect the depth of expertise and institutional knowledge it continues to nurture.





Trade in services as the other lens for measuring our economies

George William Zziwa, Statistics Department

Did you know that when we talk about international trade, we may be overlooking one of the most important ways countries interact with the world? In an age where value is increasingly created through ideas, skills, data, innovation, and expertise, should trade in services be taking centre stage in how we assess economic performance?

Did you know that every airline ticket, online subscription, consultancy fee, freight service, insurance premium, or tourist expense represents international trade—even though no physical goods cross a border? And if these invisible transactions move foreign exchange and influence economic policy just as much as goods trade, should they not matter just as much?

Did you know that within the Balance of Payments, trade in services is made up of 12 distinct components? These include manufacturing services on physical inputs, maintenance and repair, transport, travel, construction, insurance and pension services, financial services, charges for the use of intellectual property, telecommunications and information and communications technology (ICT) services, other business services, personal, cultural and recreational services, and government goods and services. And with the upcoming Balance of Payments Manual 7 (BPM7) framework, this structure is expected to expand to about 17 components, mirroring the growing complexity of global economic activity.

If services already cut across nearly every sector of the economy, could trade in services be the lens through which we should be rethinking how economies are measured, compared, and understood?

At the Bank of Uganda, trade in services data is compiled as part of our quarterly Balance of Payments statistics. Understanding this 'invisible trade' is essential for comprehensive economic analysis and informed policymaking.



Planning for Cash in a Digitalizing Economy: Managing Complexity in a Changing Payments Landscape

Agnes Akello, Currency Department

ntroduction: A Complex Operating Environment

Working in cash planning today means operating at the intersection of two powerful and seemingly divergent trends. Uganda's payments landscape is digitalising rapidly. Mobile money, electronic transfers, and card payments continue to expand in both reach and visibility. At the same time, the demand for physical cash has not declined in the manner that many had anticipated.

Cash planners are frequently confronted with this apparent contradiction. The rise of non-cash payments might suggest a diminishing role for physical currency. Yet, when one examines cash in circulation, denomination demand, and seasonal pressures, cash remains firmly embedded in the economy. Planning for it has grown more complex, requiring more sophisticated approaches and a clearer understanding of what is driving demand.

When Theory Meets Operational Reality

The assumption that digital payments substitute for cash is intuitively appealing. It aligns with cost rationalisation narratives and with the global discourse on cash-lite economies. Operational experience, however, presents a more nuanced picture.

In practice, cash demand is shaped by more than transactional activity alone. Precautionary behaviour, trust, informality, and the need for liquidity in environments where digital infrastructure remains uneven are all significant factors. In Uganda, cash continues to serve as a store of value and a reliable fallback option, particularly in rural areas and informal markets.

Electronic payments offer clear advantages in terms of convenience, speed, and traceability. They enable remote and contactless transactions without the need to carry physical currency, allow near-instant settlement across distances, and generate transaction records that enhance transparency and financial system oversight.

Recognising the Trade-offs: Cash and Digital Payments

Both cash and digital payments have distinct strengths and limitations. A balanced assessment is essential to avoid overstating the advantages of either instrument at the expense of an accurate understanding of the other.

Cash offers resilience, privacy, and universal accessibility. It is, however, operationally intensive and costly to produce, transport, secure, and process. It lacks traceability, which limits its usefulness for formal record-keeping and compliance oversight, and it is vulnerable to theft, loss, and counterfeiting. Handling large volumes can be cumbersome and inefficient.

Digital payments provide convenience, speed, and transaction records that support transparency and financial system integrity. They depend, however, on electricity, telecommunications networks, and functional devices. They are exposed to cybersecurity and fraud risks, may involve transaction costs for users, and can exclude individuals with limited digital access or literacy. Operational disruptions on major platforms can also carry system-wide consequences.

These trade-offs suggest that the more productive question is how both instruments can coexist within a resilient and inclusive payments ecosystem, given that each addresses vulnerabilities inherent in the other. For planners and policymakers, the objective is to manage balance rather than to accelerate displacement.

In Uganda's evolving financial ecosystem, individuals and businesses frequently use both instruments, selecting the one that best fits the context of the transaction or the purpose of holding funds. For cash planners, this functional differentiation explains why digital growth does not automatically translate into proportional reductions in currency demand. Instead, it reshapes the nature and drivers of that demand.

Cash and Digital Payments: What We See in Practice

From an operational standpoint, cash and digital payments function in close interaction. The growth of mobile money, for example, has expanded access to financial services and has simultaneously increased demand for cash at agent locations. Cash-in and cash-out services, agent liquidity management, and informal sector transactions all depend on the continued availability of physical currency.

Digital payments have therefore changed the form of cash demand rather than eliminating it. Certain denominations remain under pressure, geographic demand patterns have shifted, and volatility has increased. These are characteristics of an instrument whose role is evolving, and whose continued relevance warrants careful and sustained planning attention.

Forecasting in an Age of Uncertainty

Forecasting cash demand in an environment where traditional relationships are becoming more nuanced presents considerable challenges. Macroeconomic indicators such as GDP growth, inflation, and consumption patterns remain fundamental reference points; however, their interaction with cash demand is increasingly shaped by structural shifts in the payments landscape.

Seasonality persists, but its drivers are increasingly influenced by digital flows, behavioural responses, and episodic events such as elections or economic shocks. This makes point forecasts less reliable and elevates the importance of scenario analysis and the maintenance of adequate buffers.

Demand can be estimated, though it can no longer be justified on the basis of a single narrative or metric. Planners must therefore communicate both their assumptions and the range of uncertainty inherent in their projections, so that decision-makers can assess the basis on which cash provisioning recommendations are made.

The Management Buy-In Dilemma

Perhaps the most delicate challenge lies in navigating discussions around cost rationalisation. As digital payments expand, the costs associated with cash printing, storage, transportation, processing, and destruction are understandably subject to scrutiny. There is often an implicit expectation that these costs should decline rapidly as part of the digitalisation dividend.

From a planning perspective, this expectation creates a genuine dilemma. While cost efficiency is essential, reducing cash provision on the basis of assumptions rather than observed demand carries real risks. Cash shortages undermine public confidence, disrupt economic activity, and ultimately impose costs far greater than those saved through premature rationalisation.

Making the case for adequate cash provisioning therefore requires articulating clearly that sustained cash demand reflects the structure of the economy and the behavioural realities of its participants, rather than any shortcoming in the digitalisation process.

Reframing the Conversation Internally

Securing management buy-in requires a deliberate reframing of how cash is discussed within the institution. Cash warrants understanding as a core public good and a pillar of monetary credibility. Adequate stock levels represent a form of insurance against uncertainty and should be assessed on that basis, taking into account the cost implications of under-provision as much as those of excess holdings.

Evidence is equally important in this conversation. Disaggregated analysis by denomination, region, and usage purpose demonstrates that cash demand is uneven across the economy and cannot be managed effectively through across-the-board reductions. Integrating payment system data into cash planning discussions has proven valuable in building a shared understanding of demand dynamics across internal stakeholders.

Adapting How We Plan

In response to these operational realities, cash planning must continue to adapt. This requires separating transactional demand from precautionary and store-of-value demand, paying closer attention to mobile money cash-out behaviour and agent liquidity needs, applying scenario-based planning in preference to single-point forecasts, and communicating assumptions, risks, and trade-offs clearly to decision-makers. These adjustments reflect the kind of responsible planning practice that a complex and evolving payments environment demands.

Conclusion: Planning for Resilience

The experience of planning for cash in a digitalising economy confirms that the role of cash is changing, even as cash itself remains central to the payments ecosystem. Digital payments are transforming the landscape, but physical currency retains a meaningful and enduring function across households, businesses, and economic sectors.

For those involved in cash planning, the task is to manage uncertainty, balance cost pressures, and ensure continuity of supply in a manner that supports public confidence and financial stability. In a cash-lite economy, effective cash planning is centred on building resilience and ensuring that the payments system as a whole can serve all participants, under all conditions.







Personality, Character and Maturity

Jacqueline P.N. Kigonya, Commercial Banking Department

St Augustine famously said, "*Know thyself then live,*" meaning one cannot expect to be fully alive unless they know who they are. Contemporary thought would summarise this into two key questions that each of us must answer: Who am I? and Why am I here?

This article is an attempt at answering the first question. Who we are is fundamentally defined by our personality, the character which is formed out of that personality, and the gradual stability of our character over time, which is maturity.

Personality

Personality is a stable way of relating to oneself and to the world. It reveals itself in one's dealings with other people and is thus difficult to identify in someone who lives in isolation. Personality reveals itself in three basic ways: emotions, thoughts, and behaviours.

Features of personality

1.Personality has a dynamic structure. While relatively stable, it is not rigid: it can change for better or worse as new life events demand new strategies and responses. Over time, personality predisposes both our internal reactions and our external behaviour, shaping our capacity for happiness, relationships, and meaning.

2.Personality makes a person predictable. However, being predictable is not contrary to freedom; we are not machines that react the same way every time. It means that our initial impulse is to react in a particular manner.

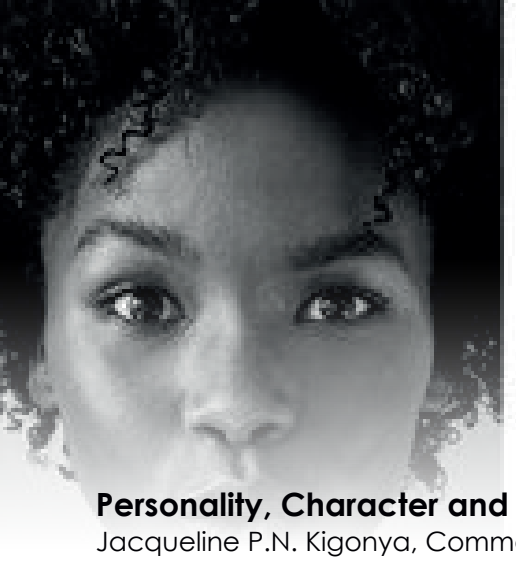
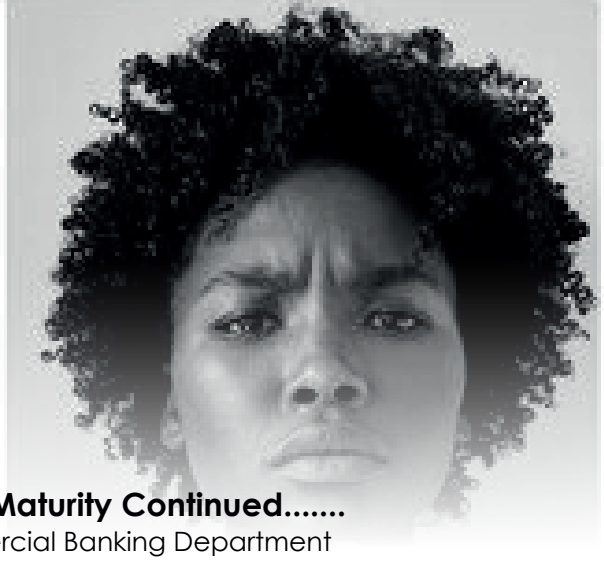
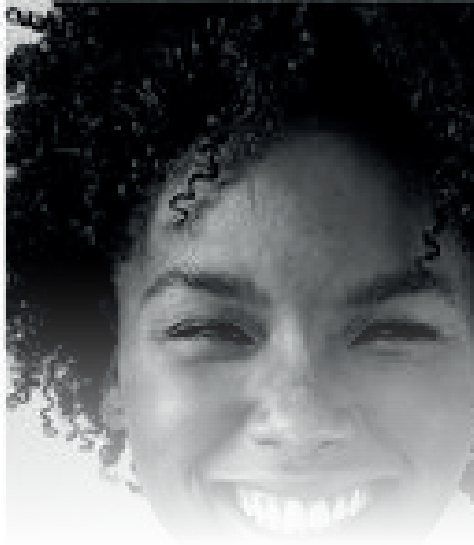
Dimensions of personality

There are two dimensions of personality, namely temperament and character.

Temperament is a set of biological, hereditary, genetic, or hormonal features. It is the foundation of our personality, the default way in which we think, feel, and act. It is the least malleable component of personality; while we will carry it with us throughout life, we can make it smoother with time, patience, and formation. There are four temperaments: choleric, melancholic, phlegmatic, and sanguine. They manifest in a greater or lesser degree of anxiety, action, reactivity, introversion or extroversion. Most people have the traits of at least two temperaments, with one more dominant than the other. One should strive to know their own temperament as well as those of their spouse, children, and work colleagues to understand and relate better with them. A summary of the key traits of each temperament is below.

Continued on Page 14

Temperament	Core Traits	Key Strengths	Common Weaknesses / Growth Areas
Sanguine	Outgoing, enthusiastic, expressive, people-oriented	•Builds relationships easily •Energizes teams and boosts morale •Adaptable and optimistic •Communicates ideas clearly	•May lack follow-through •Easily distracted •Can avoid difficult or tedious tasks •May prioritize popularity over results
Choleric	Decisive, driven, goal-oriented, assertive	•Strong leadership and initiative •Results-focused and efficient •Comfortable with responsibility •Thrives under pressure	•Can be impatient or domineering •May overlook others' feelings •Struggles with delegation •Risk of burnout or rigidity
Melancholic	Analytical, thoughtful, detail-oriented, reflective	• High standards and quality output •Strong planning and analysis •Conscientious and reliable •Deep sense of responsibility	•Prone to overthinking or perfectionism •May be slow to act •Can become discouraged easily •Difficulty coping with ambiguity
Phlegmatic	Calm, steady, diplomatic, patient	• Stabilizes teams and reduces conflict •Good listener and mediator •Consistent and dependable •Works well in collaboration	•May resist change •Avoids confrontation •Can lack initiative •Risk of complacency

Personality, Character and Maturity Continued.....

Jacqueline P.N. Kigonya, Commercial Banking Department

Take a pause to reflect on which aspects of your temperament serve you well at work—and which ones you tend to excuse rather than form.

Temperament explains our natural tendencies but not the quality of our choices. For that, we must turn to character.

Character

On the foundation of temperament, we build character. Character encompasses the features acquired through family, education, culture, values assimilated, personal relationships, decisions made, and personal struggles. Character is more amenable to change.

The task of building character should comprise the cultivation of good habits or virtues. The word "character" is derived from the Ancient Greek word "charaktêr," referring to a mark impressed upon a coin. The virtues stamp character on our temperament so that temperament ceases to dominate us. Through character we compensate for the weakness of our temperament.

We are often tempted to do what "comes naturally" even if it leads us to do things that are far from excellent. This raises a quiet but important question: when faced with difficulty, do we rely more on instinct—or on formation? Character impels us to resist this temptation and do the right thing.

The most important virtues are:

•**Prudence** has to do with making right decisions through deliberation and discernment.

•**Courage** encompasses running risks and staying the course.

•**Self-mastery** means directing our passions, that is, subduing disordered ones while energising noble ones.

•**Justice** entails giving each one his due and promoting the common good.

•**Magnanimity** is striving toward great things, that is, a firm confidence in the highest possibilities of human nature.

•**Humility** is knowing oneself and serving others.

Virtues reinforce our personality, rendering it stable and even-tempered. They enable us to rise above ourselves, our self-centredness, and focus our concern on God and others. A virtuous person is "poised," with the right measure in all things, upright, self-possessed, and well-rounded. Those who are short on virtue, in contrast, will find it hard to undertake significant projects or to give shape to high ideals. They will be forever improvising and lurching to and fro, and end up being unreliable, even for themselves. It is helpful to ask oneself periodically, *How does my character affect not just my performance, but my relationships?*

Maturity

The word "maturity" means being ripe, fully developed, and by extension it refers to the fullness of being. To grow in maturity means to learn to live our life in keeping with high ideals. Maturity expresses itself across three interconnected dimensions, each reinforcing the others

Taken together, these forms of maturity allow a person to engage reality with clarity, steadiness, and generosity.

A path to maturity

*Maturity is a process that requires time and passes t*hrough various moments and stages. Its growth is usually gradual, although specific events in a person's life can lead to rapid advances. For example, the birth of a first child is a milestone that can suddenly wake a person up to the implications of this new responsibility. Or going through serious economic hardships can result in a new evaluation of what is truly important in life.

The balance that maturity provides will help a person to react appropriately to the stressors which they will undoubtedly find and give things their due importance. Our self-reflection can be assisted by asking, *Where have life events accelerated my maturity? Where might I still be resisting growth?*

Understanding personality, character, and maturity does more than explain individual differences; it offers a shared language for growth. It reminds us that while we begin life with certain dispositions, we are not confined by them.

The ongoing task—personal and collective—is to cultivate character and maturity in a way that allows each person to contribute their best, not only through competence but through steadiness, self-mastery, and concern for others.

This raises questions worth reflecting on together: How are we being formed by our choices? And how do our personal paths of growth shape our work, family life, and community?

Virtues	Core Traits
Intellectual maturity	•an adequate self-concept (with a close correspondence between how one views oneself and how one really is, firmly based on sincerity with oneself). •clearly defined personal goals and purposes, with open and unlimited horizons. •a harmonious set of values. •ethical and moral certainty. •a healthy realism in relation to oneself and others. •the capacity for reflection and calm analysis of problems. •creativity and initiative.
Emotional maturity	•balanced reactions to life's events, without being discouraged by failure or becoming unrealistic after success. •the capacity for flexible and constructive self-control. •the ability to love and to give oneself generously to others. •confidence and firmness in decisions and commitments. •serenity and the ability to overcome challenges and difficulties. •optimism, cheerfulness, friendliness and good humor.
Social maturity	•a sincere affection for others, respecting their rights and seeking to discover and remedy their needs. •being understanding when faced with a diversity of opinions, values or cultural features, without falling into prejudices. •independence and a critical capacity in the face of a dominant culture, pressure groups or fashions. •naturalness in one's behavior that leads to acting without mere conventionalism. •the capacity to listen and understand. •the ability to work with others.

Fully on your route

Hope Kobusinge, People and Culture Department



If you have ever used Google Maps, you know it gives options: drive, ride, walk, sometimes even "avoid traffic." The destination remains the same, but the routes and arrival times differ. And yet, when it comes to our own growth, we often act as though there is only one acceptable way to arrive.

It is easy to look around and compare speed: who moved faster, who got there first, who seems ahead. But not all journeys are meant to look the same. Some routes are express lanes, some are steady and scenic, and others require pauses. Walking does not mean you are lost. Riding slower does not mean you lack direction. Taking a different road does not change the destination.

Operating at full capacity is not about rushing. It is about being intentional. It means checking whether you are still aligned with where you want to go and adjusting when necessary. Sometimes all it takes is a quiet moment to ask yourself whether you are moving with purpose or simply moving.

Growth is not defined by speed. It is defined by direction. Arrive your way, but do not shrink on the journey.







Burnout at work: Am I affected?

Dr. Gyaviira Makanga, Medical Services Department

Burnout is a three-dimensional response to emotional, physical, and mental exhaustion caused by excessive, prolonged, and continuous work-related stress. It occurs when one feels overwhelmed, emotionally drained, and physically exhausted, leading to an inability to meet constant demands at work, home, or in executing other obligations. Burnout is common in institutions and poses a danger to the institution and the individual, as it can lead to serious complications, including severe depression or death in rare circumstances.

Who is at risk

Everyone is at risk of burnout; however, in the banking sector, individuals with high-pressure roles, long hours (over 8-9 hours daily), and heavy client-facing responsibilities face an increased risk of burnout.

How to identify burnout

Unfortunately, the symptoms of burnout are "vague" and often confusing, even for a healthcare worker.

Non-physical symptoms

The non-physical symptoms include:

•Feeling drained

•Lack of energy to work

•Lack of motivation

•Chronic tiredness that may not improve with rest

•Poor concentration

•Forgetfulness

•A cynical outlook towards work and colleagues

•Procrastinating

•Low productivity

•Feeling disconnected from work or colleagues

•Irritability

•Frustration

•Mood swings affecting relationships at work and home

•Unexplained violent behaviour

Physical symptoms

Physical symptoms may vary and include:

•Sleep disturbances

•Chronic tiredness

•Headaches

•Changes in appetite, like loss of appetite or emotional eating, where individuals consume comfort foods that are most often unhealthy

•High blood pressure

•Muscle aches and a tense body

Burnout also affects the immune system, which manifests with recurrent infections like frequent viral flus or colds due to a suppressed immune system.

It is important to note that the symptoms of burnout mimic many other disease conditions, hence the need for a proper assessment by a qualified healthcare worker to exclude other ailments. Self-medication tends to be common among those affected, often with unnecessary drugs. Medicating with drugs (either self-prescribed or medically prescribed) when blood tests show no evidence of disease—for example, having a negative malaria or typhoid test—should alert you and prompt the health worker to re-evaluate and assess for other possible causes of the symptoms. Remember, unnecessary medication(s) can cause unwanted side effects which may manifest with symptoms and signs similar to those of burnout, making the actual diagnosis even more difficult.

How is burnout handled?

The first step is to recognise the "red flags" within yourself—which are the symptoms and signs of burnout. Secondly, seek help as soon as possible. This could be from a trusted colleague, a mental health professional like a counsellor or psychiatrist, or a healthcare worker, for example, a nurse or medical doctor, to assess and confirm the diagnosis after excluding other medical conditions.

Individual self-care is key in the management of burnout. This includes:

•Proper nutrition with a well-balanced diet

•Keeping well hydrated

•Engaging in relaxing activities like exercises, meditation, tai chi, or yoga

•Engaging in hobbies like sports, nature walks, and listening to music

•Identifying and tracking your stressors (both at work and outside work) through keeping a journal or using a simple notebook can be helpful in effectively managing the condition

•Practising mindfulness through deep breathing exercises, meditation, or yoga can help reduce the anxiety related to burnout

•Setting realistic work goals by breaking tasks into manageable parts and setting achievable goals; this helps prevent feeling overwhelmed and can improve productivity

•Taking frequent breaks during work hours to refresh the mind, for example, taking lunchtime walks in the sunlight can help reduce stress, and fostering good work relations with colleagues can help boost morale and reduce stress on an individual

At an institutional level, burnout can be managed or prevented by:

•Engaging employees in professional development opportunities like training and development programmes to help them feel valued and engaged

•Team-building exercises like retreats taken out of the work environment

•Stress management workshops to help equip employees with effective stress management techniques

•Encouraging employees at high risk of burnout to take time off regularly instead of in one big chunk to avoid prolonged buildup of stress

•Developing clear policies and guidelines for managing workplace burnout which are regularly reviewed and updated, and striving to continuously improve the workplace environment to reduce stress and burnout for all staff.





My data detective odyssey: from the van's rear to the Bank's data table

Emmanuel Engole, Statistics Department

Bruce Lee once said, 'Do not pray for an easy life; pray for the strength to endure a difficult one.' Looking back, this wisdom quietly guided my journey—one shaped not by certainty but by curiosity, resilience, and a consistent willingness to ask why.

A call that changed everything

On 30 June 2021, amid COVID-19 restrictions and global uncertainty, I sat at home wondering whether my long-awaited start at the Bank of Uganda would materialise. Then my phone rang. I was informed that transport had been arranged for my first day. In a time defined by isolation and disruption, that simple act reflected the BoU's care for its people. Gratitude took root, alongside a renewed sense of purpose.

The following morning, seated in the rear of the van with unfamiliar faces, I crossed my first professional threshold at the BoU. At the Medical Department, the Director of Medical Services encouraged me to propose new ideas and assured me of his support. His recognition of my background in critical care and health systems signalled trust and ignited a desire to contribute beyond routine clinical duties.

Curiosity meets opportunity

At the time, departmental reporting processes were largely manual, and system support depended heavily on external assistance. Alongside my clinical role, I was assigned the responsibility for Kampala Capital City Authority (KCCA) reporting and Clinic Management System (CMS) support. What initially appeared to be an administrative task quickly became an unexpected gateway into data systems and institutional reporting workflows.

One question kept resurfacing: Why do we do it this way? Challenging long-standing practices was uncomfortable, especially as a new staff member. Still, curiosity prevailed. I began developing simple analytics and sharing data-driven insights with departmental leadership, contributing to more timely reporting and highlighting opportunities for system improvement. Their encouragement affirmed a powerful lesson: innovation can emerge from anywhere, regardless of rank.

Resistance and resilience

Not all responses were positive. Quiet resistance and unspoken scepticism tested my confidence and resolve. Yet mentorship proved pivotal. Guidance and reassurance from senior leaders reminded me that institutional change often begins quietly and meets resistance before acceptance. That persistence yielded tangible results. Through collaboration with KCCA, we automated routine reporting via District Health Information System 2 (DHIS2), eliminating inefficient manual processes. I became a CMS super user while maintaining my clinical responsibilities, demonstrating that initiative, when aligned with institutional needs, can transform systems.

Growth through setbacks

My first performance appraisal did not meet my expectations, prompting a period of reflection that ultimately strengthened my professional direction. For a moment, I questioned whether my growing interest in data truly belonged within a clinical setting. A mentor's timely encouragement helped me recalibrate and rediscover a vital truth: setbacks refine capability; they do not negate purpose.

Investing in growth

With renewed focus, I enrolled for an MSc in Clinical Epidemiology and Biostatistics at Makerere University in 2022, with the support of departmental leadership. Despite scepticism from some quarters, I trusted that data-driven decision-making would increasingly shape institutional effectiveness. Completing the programme with distinction strengthened both my technical foundation and strategic outlook.

In 2023, a BoU-wide call for big data analysts marked another turning point. I stepped forward, confident that my clinical, epidemiological, and analytical skills were transferable. A subsequent workshop enabled direct engagement with the Director of Statistics, whose guidance helped position my work toward advanced analytics and cross-departmental collaboration.

Building, collaborating, contributing

Through continuous self-learning, professional certifications, and the generous support of colleagues and friends, I earned a Microsoft Power BI certification. Working closely with the Statistics and Data Governance teams, we developed dashboards that are now hosted on the Bank of Uganda Data Portal. For the first time, I felt not only invited to the data table but trusted to help build it.

The data detective moment.

Statistics Week 2025 provided a defining milestone through the 'Data Detectives: Unlocking Hidden Insights' challenge. My submission, 'The Mobile Money Paradox,' was selected as the winning entry, earning BoU-wide recognition. From the Medical Department to the institution's data spotlight, the journey had come full circle.

The journey continues.

This story is not about titles or accolades. It is about curiosity, integrity, mentorship, and the courage to ask questions. It reflects a professional journey toward bridging health systems, data analytics, and institutional decision-making.

To every colleague who feels unseen or uncertain: your questions matter. Growth often begins quietly, long before it is acknowledged. No seat is too small for a vision grounded in purpose and persistence. My data detective odyssey has been a journey from uncertainty to clarity, from aspiration to contribution. Today, I continue to work at the intersection of health systems, data, and institutional decision-making, guided by curiosity, strengthened by mentorship, and driven by the belief that good data, in the right hands, can quietly transform institutions.





Screen time and children's mental health: finding balance in a digital world

Dr. Shema Christine, Medical Services Department

Screens are now part of childhood. From online learning and entertainment to social connection, digital devices are woven into how children grow, learn, and play. For many working parents, screens are also a practical reality; they help to keep children occupied during busy schedules. The age at which children engage with media on a regular basis has fallen from four years in 1970 to four months in the present day. Electronic devices have revolutionised learning, communication, and information dissemination, but recent research indicates that screen media use may have serious adverse effects on children's health over the long term, making this a pressing public health concern. It has raised the likelihood that children will become obese, experience behavioural problems, sleep irregularities, and poor academic performance.

However, as screen time increases, concerns about its impact on children's mental health are growing.

According to the American Psychology Association, spending too much time on screens may cause emotional and behavioural problems in children, and these problems can lead to even more screen use.

Understanding the effects—both positive and negative—can help parents and caregivers guide children towards healthier digital habits.

Understanding screen time

Screen time includes any time spent on smartphones and tablets, televisions, computers and video games, and social media platforms.

Not all screen time is equal. Educational content, interactive learning, and supervised use differ significantly from prolonged passive scrolling, gaming, or exposure to inappropriate content.

How excessive screen time affects mental health

Research increasingly links excessive or unregulated screen use to several mental and emotional challenges in children and adolescents:

1. Increased anxiety and depression

Children who spend long hours on screens, especially social media, are more likely to experience anxiety, low mood, and reduced self-esteem. Constant comparison with curated online images can lead to feelings of inadequacy and social pressure, particularly in adolescents.

2. Sleep disruption

Screens emit blue light, which suppresses melatonin, the hormone responsible for sleep. Children who use screens close to bedtime often struggle to fall asleep or experience poor-quality sleep. Chronic sleep deprivation can affect mood, concentration, academic performance, and emotional regulation.

3. Reduced attention and concentration

Fast-paced digital content can shorten attention spans, making it harder for children to focus on schoolwork, reading, or face-to-face conversations. This can impact learning and behaviour, especially in younger children whose brains are still developing.

4. Social and emotional delays

Excessive screen time may replace crucial real-life interactions. Children learn empathy, communication, and emotional regulation through play and social engagement, not screens. Limited interaction can delay these skills.

5. Behavioural challenges

Irritability, aggression, and emotional outbursts have been associated with prolonged screen use, especially when children are abruptly denied access to devices.

Are screens always bad?

It is important to note that screens are not inherently harmful. When used appropriately, they can:

•Support learning and creativity

•Improve digital literacy

•Enable social connection, especially for older children

•Provide access to educational resources and health information

The issue is excessive, unsupervised, and unstructured use.

Recommended screen time guidelines

According to the American Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry, this is the recommended screen time by age:

0 to 18 months: Avoid screen time except for video calls.

Ages 18 to 24 months: No more than one hour per day. Educational content only is recommended.

Ages 2 to 5 years: One hour or less per weekday and three hours per weekend day. Educational and interactive content is preferred, but non-educational content is allowed.

Ages 6 to 12 years: Less than two hours per day. Recreational content is allowed, but healthy habits are encouraged like outdoor playing, family time, and schoolwork.

Teenagers (Ages 13 and above): Promote open conversations about balancing recreational screen time with responsibilities like homework, chores, and sleep.

What parents and caregivers can do

1. Set clear and consistent limits

Establish screen-free times like during meals and before bedtime, and screen-free zones such as bedrooms. Consistency helps children feel secure and understand boundaries.

2. Model healthy screen habits

Children learn by example. Reducing unnecessary phone use, especially during family time, reinforces positive behaviour.

3. Encourage offline activities

Promote physical activity, reading, creative play, and family interaction. These activities support emotional resilience and social development.

4. Monitor content, not just time

Know what your child is watching, playing, or scrolling through. Age-appropriate educational content is far healthier than endless passive consumption.5.

5. Prioritise sleep

Ensure devices are switched off at least one hour before bedtime. A consistent sleep routine significantly improves mental wellbeing.

6. Talk about online experiences

Create a safe space for children to discuss what they see online. Open conversations help children process emotions, identify harmful content, and seek support when needed.

When to seek professional help

Parents should consider professional advice if a child shows:

•Persistent sadness or withdrawal

•Excessive irritability or aggression

•Sleep problems that do not improve

•Declining academic performance

•Loss of interest in previously enjoyed activities

Early intervention can prevent long-term mental health challenges.

Striking the right balance

In today's digital age, the goal is not to eliminate screens but to use them wisely. Balanced screen use combined with strong family relationships, healthy routines, and open communication supports children's mental and emotional wellbeing.

As parents and caregivers, guiding children towards mindful screen habits is an investment in their long-term mental health, resilience, and overall development.

The Case for a Quarterly Personal Finance Review

Robert Owagonza, Communications & Public Relations Department

Most bankers understand the importance of managing money well. They consistently encourage the public to save regularly, budget accurately, invest wisely, and avoid taking on unsustainable debt. Yet familiarity with these principles does not always translate into consistent personal financial management. Ironically, some banking professionals rarely apply the same discipline to their own finances. Few take time to regularly assess whether their personal finances are on track. A quarterly review of your personal finances is not merely advisable, it is essential. It protects your financial wellbeing, strengthens your professional credibility, and supports your long-term wealth creation goals.

When you introduce yourself as a banker, people tend to assume financial comfort, and that assumption creates real pressure. Family members, friends, in-laws, and the broader community often hold heightened expectations. Many bankers find it difficult to decline financial requests, resulting in silent but significant strain. A quarterly review creates the space to manage those pressures with clarity and intention. Below are six reasons why every banker should build this habit into their calendar.

1. Identifying patterns and trends in your spending

A quarterly review reveals situations where you are consistently spending more than planned or taking on obligations at the expense of your own financial stability. Whether it is frequent lending to friends, unplanned contributions to introduction ceremonies, weddings and funerals, or lifestyle expenses that exceed your income, reviewing your finances every three months helps you identify the financial leakages that need to be addressed. Crucially, this exercise surfaces not just isolated incidents but recurring patterns, showing you where you may need to draw the line or restructure your commitments before they derail your financial goals.

2. Evaluating discretionary and social spending

For bankers, discretionary and social spending can escalate quietly because of the professional image one is expected to maintain. Networking events, social gatherings, and family obligations create subtle financial leaks that accumulate over time. A quarterly review compels you to examine where your money is going beyond essential needs like non-critical spending such as weekend socialising, expensive gifts, and impulse purchases. The review helps you to determine whether these habits support or undermine your financial wellbeing. Over a three-month window, patterns become clearer, allowing you to make informed adjustments that protect both your wallet and your long-term plans.

3. Maintaining accountability and financial discipline

Every banker knows the principles of financial discipline but applying them personally can be challenging. A quarterly review acts as a built-in accountability checkpoint that reinforces your boundaries especially in a profession where people often assume you always have access to money.

By regularly assessing your spending and obligations, you strengthen your ability to say no where necessary. Without firm boundaries, small acts of generosity or social pressure can escalate into long-term financial strain. Reviewing your finances quarterly reminds you of your priorities, helps you adhere to your limits, and nurtures discipline in areas such as saving, borrowing, expense tracking, investment, and retirement planning.

4. Aligning spending with your financial goals, not social expectations

Many bankers unintentionally shape their spending around social expectations, attending every event, contributing to every fundraiser, or attempting to match colleagues' lifestyles, all of which can be financially draining. A quarterly review helps you step back and realign spending with your personal financial goals, whether that means building an emergency fund, investing, repaying a loan, or preparing for retirement. When you review your finances every three months, you are reminded of what truly matters for your future. You become more intentional, choosing to spend in ways that move you closer to your financial goals rather than reacting to social pressure. Over time, you develop the confidence to prioritise your own financial growth while managing relationships responsibly.

5. Managing debt accumulation early

The professional environment of banking can mask personal financial risk. Easy access to financial products including building loans, general purpose advances, emergency mobile money loans, and staff cooperative loans means that debt can accumulate quietly. It is easy to assume that proximity to financial systems confers immunity from mismanagement, yet the reverse can be true: banker-specific pressures can distort personal decision-making.

A quarterly review allows you to consolidate your total debt position, compare interest rates and repayment schedules, adjust repayment plans before debt becomes burdensome, and avoid the reputational consequences that can arise from salary attachments. It pulls you back into reality by forcing an honest assessment of how many loans you are servicing and whether your financial habits remain aligned with your long-term financial goals.

6. Planning for long-term wealth creation and retirement

Internal knowledge-sharing sessions on retirement planning have reinforced a consistent message: personal responsibility is essential to ensuring a dignified retirement. A quarterly review supports this by prompting you to evaluate your retirement contributions, assess investment performance, rebalance your portfolio, and reassess your risk tolerance as your circumstances change. Short-term spending pressures should not be allowed to overshadow long-term financial security.

Ultimately, a quarterly review of your personal finances is not a luxury. It is critical discipline that keeps you aware, in control, and aligned with your financial goals. It protects your financial wellbeing, reduces stress, and ensures that the principles you apply professionally are equally honoured at home. Set aside time on your calendar each quarter to review your financial statements, revisit your goals, and take honest stock of your spending habits. The bankers who serve Uganda's financial system most credibly are those who have first put their own house in order.







The weight of expectations

Boaz Niwamanya, Currency Department

Some waiting does not look like waiting.
It breathes, it walks, it answers calls.

Yet somewhere inside, a chair remains empty.

A future moment is given a name and a promise.

Until it arrives, everything else is provisional.

Time keeps moving, but meaning lingers ahead,

just out of reach.

Notifications begin to feel ceremonial.

A vibration becomes a verdict.

The inbox is opened and reopened,

as though repetition might persuade silence to speak.

What starts as attention turns ritual,

then a habit,

then something close to something like an OCD,

checking as prayer, refreshing as hope.

Edges begin to fray.

Anger appears without warning.

The small, necessary acts—eating, arriving, completing—

lose weight and fall away.

Walking becomes a conversation with no listener.

Words are spoken into air.

Curses slip out—softly, like steam escaping a crack.

Information grows strange.

Rumours feel warm.

False memos carry comfort.

Truth is not rejected—it is simply tiring.

Anything that breaks the stillness is welcomed,

even if it bends.

Sleep thins.

Attention drifts.

Days are lived—but not entirely occupied.

A portion of the self remains elsewhere,

standing by a door that has not opened.

And yet— Not all waiting is hollow.

There are moments, brief and unannounced,

when the present reclaims its voice.

A meal tastes like itself again.

A step lands fully on the ground.

Breath returns without being summoned.

Expectation loosens its grip not by force,

but by attention shifting back to what is here.

The future does not disappear—

It simply stops demanding tribute.

Some discover this quietly.

Others arrive there by fatigue.

Either way, the hands begin to open.

The chair inside is no longer empty—

It is occupied by now.

The awaited moment may still come,

or it may change its shape entirely.

But something essential has already returned:

The ability to live without postponement.

And in that return,

the weight becomes lighter—

not because the future has spoken,

but because the present has learned

It does not need permission.





Why keyboards never get lost

Lynda Namukwaya, Statisitcs Department

In a quiet office where computers hummed softly and papers shuffled themselves into tiny mountains, there lived a cheerful little keyboard named Kibo. Every morning, Kibo woke up ready to type, click, and clack his way through the day.

But Kibo had one problem: he was extremely curious.

Whenever the office lights went off in the evening, he loved exploring. One night, he slid off the desk and wandered around the office, past the printer snoring in sleep mode, under the spinning office chairs, and even through the jungle of tangled cables behind the desks.

Suddenly, everything went dark. Kibo froze.

'Uh-oh, where am I?' he whispered.

He tried to remember the path he took, but all the desks looked the same in the dark. His tiny keyboard heart began to race.

'I am lost!' he squeaked.

Just then, a soft glow appeared from the key right where his thumb would rest. It was the Home key, shining brighter than usual.

'Do not panic,' the Home key said gently.

Kibo took a deep breath, followed the warm glow, and slowly slid back across the office. Chair legs, cables, and shadows no longer frightened him. The glow grew brighter the closer he got. At last, he found his desk. He climbed up the chair, hopped onto the table, and settled back into his place. He sighed in relief. The Home key winked.

'As long as you remember where 'home' is, you will always find your way.'

Did you know? *The Home key on your keyboard takes the cursor to the beginning of a line or document. In early computing, it literally brought users 'home' to the start of their work. Press Ctrl+Home to jump to the very beginning of a document, your way of finding home in a digital workspace.*



I Hope this Comic Finds You Well

Verstinah Mwiza Baguma and Lynda Namukwaya, Statistics Department







A Familiar Season, Seen Again: Why Christmas at the Office Is More Than Decoration

Duncan Roy Kawooya, Monetary Policy Department

I am big on Christmas. I have been, and I suspect I always will be. Officially, especially if you were raised religiously, Christmas does not end on 25 December. The season stretches on through Epiphany and, by tradition, concludes 40 days later on 2 February with Candlemas, often referred to as 'the end of Christmas'. By that definition, we are still well within our rights to talk about Christmas long after the decorations come down.

Apparently, I am not alone. What began as a quiet personal habit many years ago with a few lights and some tinsel around my computer monitor slowly expanded. First within the cubicle, then the Eastern corridor on Level 8. At some point, with little ceremony, the lobby on Level 8 followed. The enthusiasm proved contagious. The ITO/ID Team on Level 5 caught it next, and if there is such a thing as Christmas intensity, they brought it in full force. Before long, the spirit had travelled further still, down to Level 4 of the new building. Two Christmases ago was not the same.

What started as decoration became something else entirely. And then came 2023. While the rest of us were sleeping, the long-quiet giant on Level 4 of the old building woke up. By 2024, there was no contest. They simply nailed it. There was no competing or debating; we accepted it.

The NPSD display was something else entirely. Elegant ribbons cascaded through the space, carrying suspended Christmas ornaments that caught the light just right. The overall effect was striking, rich, deliberate, and unmistakably festive. It reminded me of Kelly Clarkson's 'Wrapped in Red': bold, warm, and confidently joyful. I am told this sudden excellence may have had something to do with the arrival of a fellow Christmas enthusiast on that floor, a theory I am still investigating.

Level 5 – Two IT Teams. One floor. No small ideas.

Simply put, they slayed and then kept going. Reindeer, balloons, sweets, and ornaments appeared to float from the ceiling on invisible strings. There was music too, somewhere, discreetly hidden; a Bluetooth speaker delivered Christmas ballads throughout the day, at all hours. It was immersive, joyful, and unapologetically festive. Part of what made it work was scale. There is real power in numbers, and IT has them. But just as important has been the recent infusion of fresh energy with newer faces, new ideas, and a willingness to try things without overthinking them. The result was a space that felt lively, confident, and genuinely happy.

Level 4 – New Building: Accounts and Funds Management Department

The people who manage the money clearly know how to put it to work. Late to the party this time, but not without impact. Their green-and-grey palette certainly lifted the mood. That said, opinion was divided, largely among those who sit on Level 4 themselves. Some felt the aesthetic leaned a little too close to 'hospital chic', which, in fairness, may be the harshest critique Christmas décor can receive. Still, this is a floor that carries significant responsibility; they own the money and it shows even in how it decorates. Like others, Level 4 has also seen an injection of younger energy, and the attempt itself mattered. The willingness to experiment, however cautiously, signalled movement and openness, which is no small thing.

Level 6: People and Culture Department; Administrative Services Department

This was the surprise. Typically restrained, Level 6 came alive with warm reds, golds, greens, and whites; everything recognizably Christmas but measured. Fittingly, they were also the last to take their display down. As quiet custodians of institutional culture, Level 6 reflected a culture in transition, still respectful of tradition, yet clearly evolving.

Level 8: The Department, formerly known as Research

Here, I must declare bias and conflict of interest because I live here. Still, the choice was clear: warmth over spectacle. Soft lights, and carefully placed boxes, and a palette of yellow and gold created a calm, welcoming glow. Perhaps unsurprisingly, this floor is home to what some might call the 'unofficial uncle of Christmas'; someone who believes deeply in the season, its rituals, and its quiet power.

Level 4 – Old Building: National Payment Systems Department (NPSD)

Whatever the secret ingredient is, it is working. Once again, they delivered. Before a single decoration went up, they produced a departmental Christmas card, featuring a pyramid of staff faces arranged to form a Christmas tree. They even managed to get TT (yes, he has allowed us to call him so) to wear a reindeer headband. At that point, it was clear something special was happening.

People in that Department genuinely like each other, enough, at least, to appear together on a Christmas card. The card was displayed on the visual communications board and from there, the floor followed suit. NPSD, it is only fair to say: you are firmly up there with Mariah Carey as royalty in the Christmas Hall of Fame. You win. Let us move on.

This assessment does not include the Bank-wide Christmas displays, such as the glowing tree on Shimoni Road or the giant tree outside the banking hall. Perhaps in 2026, as we turn 60, we can be a little bolder and brighter. A few well-placed strip lights across our buildings might do the trick, bringing warmth and sparkling to the city without turning the Bank into a Las Vegas nightclub.

Christmas has a way of inviting us to see familiar spaces differently. If you are reading this after 31 March 2026, know that there are roughly 269 days until Christmas. That is ample time to plan. The season, after all, has a way of returning, familiar, and yet seen again.



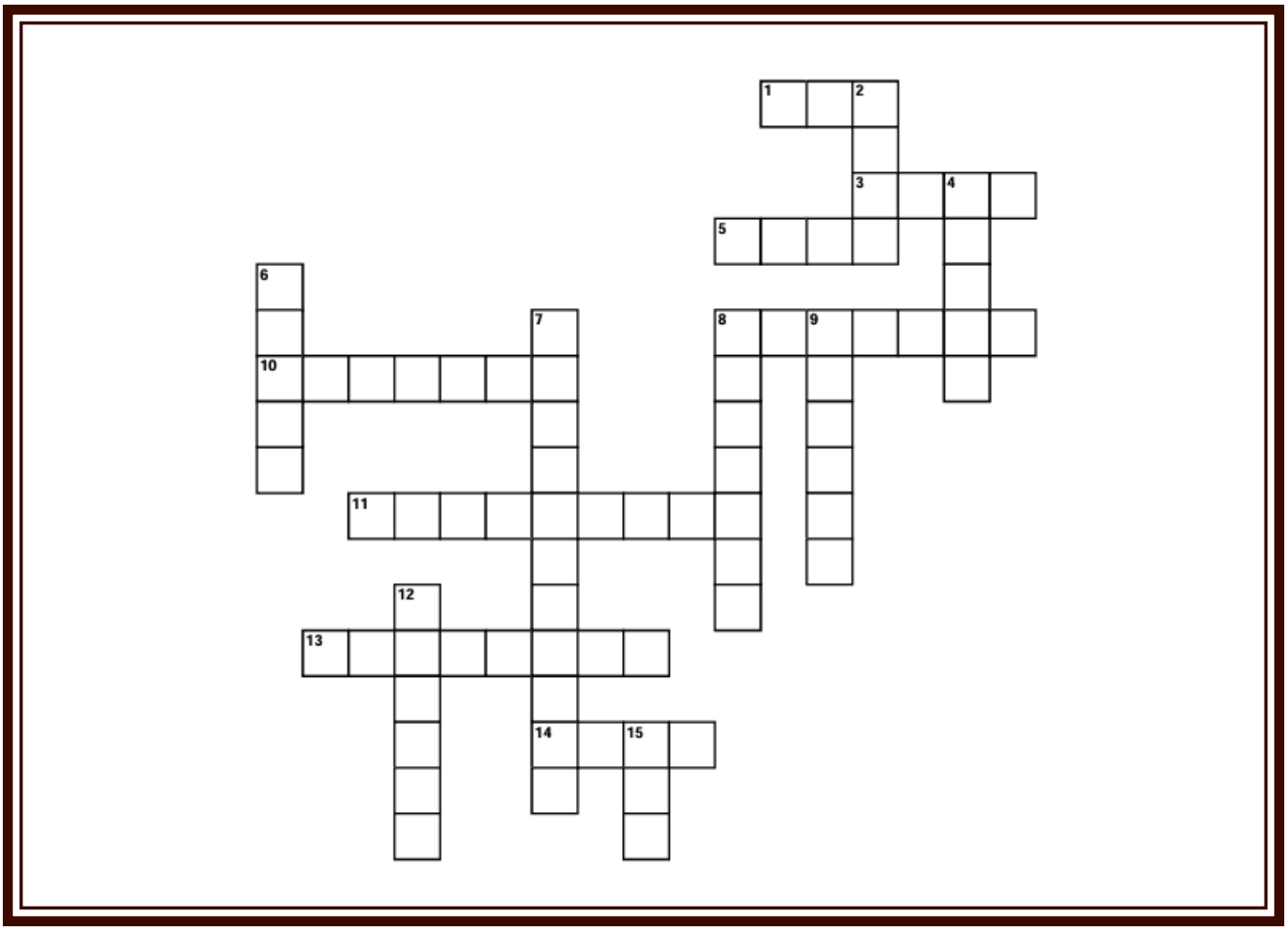








BoU Facts Crossword Puzzle 6



Across

[1] Policy rate introduced in July 2011 (acronym)_____(3).
[3] Northern Uganda city where an EACB sub centre opened on 29 January 1962_____(4).
[5] East African cross-border payment system implemented in 2013 (acronym)_____(3).
[8] Bank that acquired 80% of UCBL in November 2001_____(7).
[10] Surname of the Tanganyikan leader who championed an East African federation_____(7).
[11] Surname of the Governor appointed on 11 May 1990_____(9).
[13] The pre 1966 East African currency board kept the shilling at par with the Pound _____(8).
[14] Acronym of the regional currency issuer replaced by the new central banks in 1966_____(4).Down

Down

[2] High-value payment system implemented at BoU in February 2005 (acronym)_____(4).
[4] Deputy Governor named alongside Governor Joseph Mary Mubiru in 1966_____(5).
[6] Town that hosted the EACB's main currency office in Uganda from 1927_____(5).
[7] In May 1987 the currency was _____ by a factor of 100_____(11).
[8] Road name of the BoU building opened in 1988_____(7).
[9] City recommended by the Blumenthal Commission as the seat of a proposed East African central bank_____(6).
[12] German era small coin that gave rise to the "hela tano" nickname for 10 cents_____(6).
[15] Securities settlement platform implemented in 2013 (acronym)_____(3).



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Mission: To Promote Price Stability and a Sound Financial System in Support of Socio-economic Transformation in Uganda.
Vision: To be a centre of excellence in upholding macroeconomic stability.

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